

The World of Eldrasil

Chapter 1: The Sundering

Three hundred years ago, the realm of Eldrasil was a single unbroken continent ruled by the Sunfire Dynasty. The Sundering was a magical catastrophe caused by the wizard Velmorath, who attempted to bind the souls of the dead into an army of eternal soldiers. The ritual failed catastrophically, tearing the continent into three floating shards: Highspire, the Ashlands, and the Drowned Reach.

Velmorath himself was not killed in the Sundering. Local legends claim he was transformed into a being of pure shadow, now known only as the Hollow King, who is said to dwell beneath the Ashlands in a fortress called Karneth Hollow.

Chapter 2: The Three Shards

Highspire is the largest remaining shard, home to the city of Aurel's Rest. It is governed by the Council of Twelve Houses and is considered the safest region in Eldrasil, though bandit activity has increased near the Thornwood border in recent years.

The Ashlands is a blighted shard covered in volcanic ash, home to the Hollow King's forces. Few travelers return from the Ashlands. Those who do speak of ash wraiths, creatures of smoke and bone that hunt by sound rather than sight.

The Drowned Reach is a swampy shard perpetually shrouded in mist, ruled loosely by the Tidecaller clans. The Reach is known for the Sunken Library, an ancient archive partially submerged in black water, said to contain knowledge from before the Sundering.

Chapter 3: Notable NPCs

Mira Thornquist — Captain of the Highspire Guard. Gruff but fair, she distrusts magic users due to losing her brother in the Sundering. She offers quests related to bandit activity near the Thornwood.

Old Cobb — A blind hermit who lives at the edge of the Thornwood. He claims to speak with the spirits of those lost in the Sundering and often gives cryptic prophecies to travelers who bring him firewood.

The Hollow King (Velmorath) — The primary antagonist of the Eldrasil campaign setting. He seeks to complete his original ritual by gathering seven Soulshards, each hidden in a different shard of the broken continent.

Chapter 4: House Rules

Critical hits in this campaign deal double damage dice, not double total damage. Resting at the Sunken Library grants advantage on the next Intelligence check made within 24 hours, due to residual magic in the archive. Ash wraiths native to the Ashlands are immune to fire damage and vulnerable to radiant damage.